

D.J. PARIS

REPLYING IN FOUR MINUTES IS A MISTAKE.

You just taught your client to expect that speed forever.

D.J. Paris
Keeping It Real Podcast

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**THE FAST REPLY
ISN'T THE
PROBLEM. THE
SILENCE
AFTERWARD IS.**

Answer in four minutes once, at 9pm, on a Sunday,
and that's the new normal you set.

YOU DIDN'T PICK A POLICY. YOU PICKED A PRECEDENT.

Every reply time you've ever sent trains your client on what to expect next. Answer fast enough, often enough, and the client stops reading it as responsiveness. They read it as your baseline. The fix isn't replying slower on purpose. It's deciding the policy before the client decides it for you.

SET THIS BEFORE YOUR NEXT NEW CLIENT, NOT AFTER:

- 1 State your hours out loud, on day one.**
"8am to 8pm, I respond within two hours," said once, before they need anything.
- 2 Name your stop time.**
Pick the hour you go dark for family time, and tell them that's the line, not an accident they'll discover later.
- 3 Tell them the weekend plan too.**
Whatever you actually do Saturday and Sunday, say it out loud so it's a policy, not a surprise.

THE TAKEAWAY

**CLIENTS DON'T
MIND A POLICY.
THEY MIND BEING
SURPRISED BY ONE.**

Say your hours before the first fast reply sets them for you.